

STAGE SIX • COMMUNICATION: SPEAKING, READING & WRITING

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Six • Communication: Speaking, Reading & Writing

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's exercises work best against real, existing material — your own emails, a real reading, a real piece of work — so most of this pre-work is about bringing something genuine rather than preparing in the abstract.

Before Session 1: Written Communication

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring 5–10 of your own recent sent emails accessible (for the Email Etiquette Audit).
- If you have a real report, proposal, or document draft in progress, bring it — several exercises work best with real material.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is entirely about real, existing writing. Working from your own genuine material makes every exercise more useful than a hypothetical example would.

Before Session 2: Verbal & Presentation Skills

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring your phone — multiple exercises this session involve recording yourself.
- Have your elevator pitch from earlier work accessible, since one exercise refines it further.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the most recording-heavy session in the stage. Coming prepared means session time goes to practice, not logistics.

Before Session 3: Listening, Reading & Comprehension

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring a genuinely challenging piece of reading from your field.
- Have a podcast episode or video in mind that you could reference or briefly revisit.

WHY THIS MATTERS

These exercises work far better against real content you're already engaging with than generic assigned material.

Before Session 4: Interpersonal & Networking Communication

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- No special materials required. Come ready to talk to people you may not know well in the room.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is almost entirely live interaction — the only real preparation is a willingness to engage genuinely with peers.

Before Session 5: Feedback, Reflection & Self-Assessment

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring a real piece of your own work (writing, a presentation outline, anything genuine) to use in paired feedback exercises.
- Identify one real mentor or trusted colleague you could reach out to for a communication reflection conversation.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Feedback exercises are only as useful as the real material they're applied to — generic or hypothetical work produces generic, unhelpful feedback.

Before Session 6: Communication Systems & Tools

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Reflect briefly on which of this stage's exercises felt most useful to you — you'll be asked to build ongoing systems around your own real patterns.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This closing session builds personal systems, which work best when grounded in genuine self-knowledge from the previous five sessions, not generic best practices.